

Braid Presentations for Concurrent Programs

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Abstract

Ziemiański's cube chain category $\text{Ch}(K)$ is a combinatorial model for the space of directed paths on a precubical set K . Paliga and Ziemiański built a braid invariant for precubical sets by constructing an isomorphism between $\pi_1|\text{Ch}(Z)|$ and the braid category, where Z is the terminal precubical set. However, that invariant is trivial for every $K \subseteq I^n$ [PZ21, Prop. 6.1]. This paper constructs a localization of $\text{Ch}(K)$ at morphisms that preserve the order of coordinates, called $\text{Br}(K)$. This structure is the source of the braiding structure of $\pi_1|\text{Ch}(Z)|$. But, there is no geometric realization or homotopy equivalence in this technique. Instead we build a 2-polygraph giving an artin braid-like presentation of $\text{Br}(K)$. The $\{0, 1, 2\}$ -generators of the polygraph are the dimension $\{0, 1, 2\}$ chains of K . Intuitively, 3-cells of K contribute braid relations, and pairs of non-intersecting 2-cells of K contribute commuting relations. This is not just a metaphor: at $K = Z$, we get the artin relations and generators exactly. So $\text{Br}(Z)$ is equivalent to the positive braid category. The presentation is natural in K , providing a generalization of the existing work. As an application, we establish a link to the hyperplane arrangement literature. The way braids are constructed via salvetti's theorem for the braid arrangement exactly matches the polygraph we build here for the cube. All this work is formalized in Lean [Sto26].

1 Introduction

Ziemiański's cube chain category $\text{Ch}(K)$ is a combinatorial model for the executions of a bipointed precubical set K [Zie20, Thm. 7.6]. Paliga and Ziemiański established a homotopy equivalence between the space of directed paths on Z and the configuration spaces of points in the plane [PZ21, Thm. 1.1], where Z is the terminal precubical set. It extends, by naturality, to an invariant of any precubical set K . However, it is trivial for every $K \subseteq I^n$ [PZ21, Prop. 6.1]. The proof is one line: the invariant factors through the space of directed paths on I^n , which is contractible.

This paper explains that the braid structure is present in $\text{Ch}(K)$ without passing through any homotopy equivalences. We will construct a set of morphisms, W , in $\text{Ch}(K)$. And define the localization $\text{Br}(K) := \text{Ch}(K)^{\text{op}}[(W^{\text{op}})^{-1}]$. Then we will build a 2-polygraph, $\text{Art}(K)$, giving an Artin-like presentation for $\text{Br}(K)$ in geometric terms. This approach gives us several advantages. Firstly, we preserve more structure of $\text{Ch}(K)$, so $\text{Br}(I^n)$ does not collapse. Secondly, it permits us to stay with positive braids which yields a simpler theory. The full braid group can be easily recovered via the lift to the free groupoid on $\text{Ch}(K)$.

The generators of our polygraph are straightforward. A chain of K has a list of positive integers for the dimension of the cubes. Let the degree of a chain be the sum of the list minus the length. Then the polygraph's n -generators are the degree n chains, for $n \in \{0, 1, 2\}$. The attachments of the 2-generators to paths of 1-generators will take some work to formalize, but the following pictures give a clear intuition about the attachments.

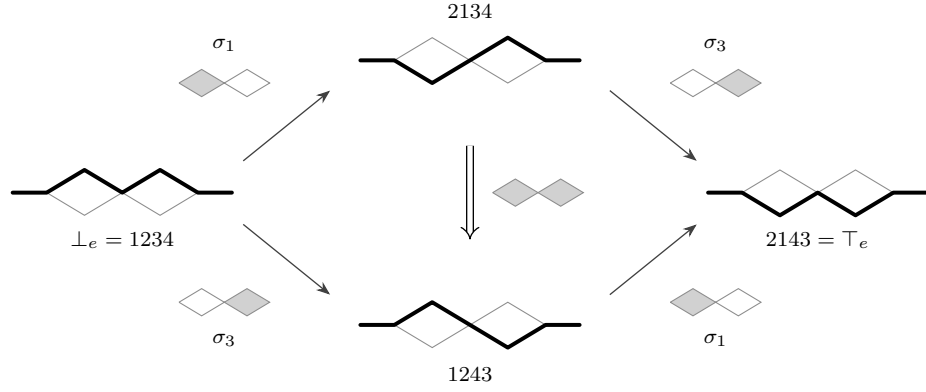


Figure 1: The four runs over the degree-two chain $e = V[2, 2]$. Each arrow is decorated with the square that witnesses the reordering. And each node is decorated with the degree 0 refinement's permutation. So the 2 cell attaches $\sigma_1\sigma_3 \rightarrow \sigma_3\sigma_1$.

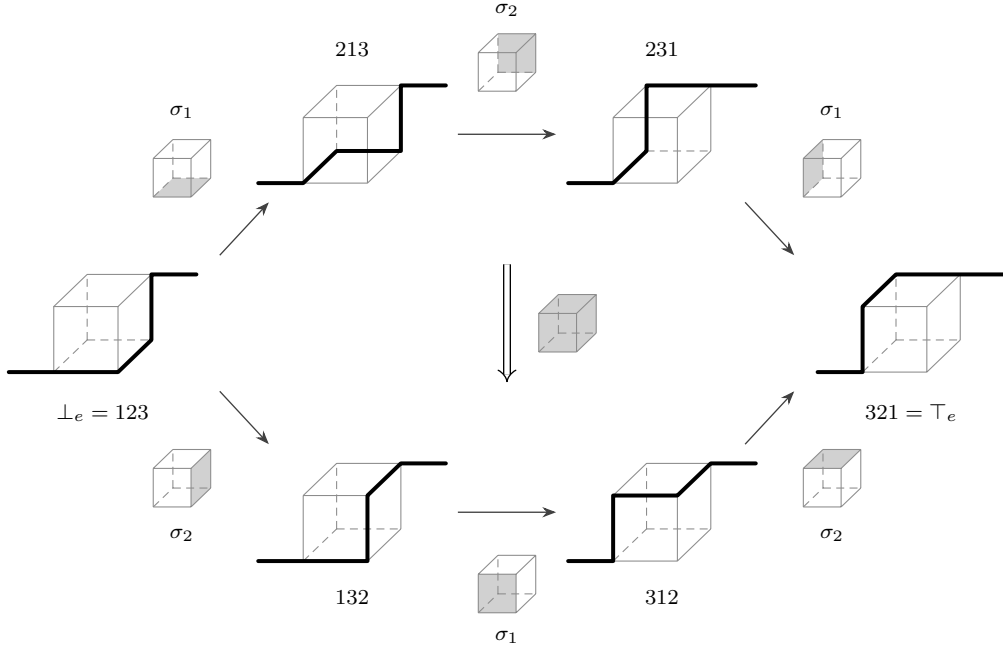


Figure 2: The six runs over the degree-two chain $e = V[3]$. Again each arrow is decorated with the square that witnesses the reordering. And each node is decorated with the degree 0 refinement's permutation. So we get the attachment $\sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_1 \rightarrow \sigma_2\sigma_1\sigma_2$.

The main results of this paper will be

Theorem 1.1 (Theorem 5.3, Theorem 6.1, Theorem 7.5). *Let K be a bipointed precubical set*

1. $\text{Art}(K)$ presents $\text{Br}(K)$, in the sense that there is an equivalence $E_K : \langle \text{Art}(K) \rangle \rightarrow \text{Br}(K)$.
2. Both constructions are functorial in K , and E is natural: for every $f : K \rightarrow L$,

$$E_L \circ \langle \text{Art}(f) \rangle = \text{Br}(f) \circ E_K.$$

3. $\text{Art}(Z)$ is isomorphic to the positive Artin polygraph for the braid category. Consequently $\text{Br}(Z)$ is equivalent to the positive braid category.

We are begging the question by naming our polygraph Art , but it is well justified in the spirit of [GGM15]. At $K = Z$, we see above that we will prove it is indeed the literal Artin presentation of the positive braids. So in general, we get a subset of the Artin relations in this presentation, depending on the presence of 3-cells of K .

Formalisation. The main results are formalised in Lean 4 on mathlib [Sto26], sorry-free. The objects $\text{Br}(K)$, W and $\text{Art}(K)$ are `ChainCat.Br`, `ChainCat.W` and `ChainCat.Paper.poly`. The three parts of Theorem 1.1 are `Paper.paperPresents`, `Paper.paperSquare` and `Paper.paperArtinIso`.

► *TODO: CubeChains/Paper.lean follows an earlier draft. Resync it with this one, one example per statement, and then say so here.*

Conventions. We assume the reader is familiar with [PZ21; Zie20] and use its notation: $\square_*$ is the category of bipointed precubical sets, with Z final and I^n the n -cube. Put $[n] := \{1, \dots, n\}$. Also, note that the ops are there because we have chosen to use the convention for $\text{Ch}(K)$ as in [Zie20]. But that won't translate across to braids conveniently. So we will need the op in the definition of Br .

2 Background

Cube chains. A **shape** is a list $a = [a_1, \dots, a_r]$ of positive integers; it names the serial wedge $\bigvee a := I^{a_1} \vee \dots \vee I^{a_r}$, whose **blocks** are the I^{a_i} , and we put $|a| := \sum_i a_i$ and $\deg a := |a| - r$. Objects of $\text{Ch}(K)$, the **chains**, are the bipointed maps $d : \bigvee a \rightarrow K$, and its morphisms, the refinements, are the maps of wedges over K . Notation defined for shapes, here and below, applies to a chain through its shape: $|d| := |a|$, $\deg d := \deg a$, and so on. We write $\text{Ch}(u)$ for the pushforward along $u : K \rightarrow L$, which postcomposes the classifying map and leaves the shape alone. A chain of degree 0 is a **run**. The subcategory of runs is discrete; we leave the check to the reader.

We use two facts from [PZ21], and the third is an easy corollary.

Lemma 2.1 ([PZ21, Ex. 2.6(c)]). *If $a = [a_1, \dots, a_r]$ is a shape, then the unique altitude function on $\bigvee a$ is given by $\text{alt}(c) = a_1 + \dots + a_{i-1} + |c^{-1}(1)|$ for $c \in I^{a_i}$.*

In particular the final vertex of $\bigvee a$ has altitude $|a|$. Moreover $\bigvee a$ is non-self-linked, by [PZ21, Prop. 2.10] applied to its blocks; we leave the details to the reader.

Lemma 2.2 ([PZ21, Prop. 2.7]). *Let P, Q be connected bipointed precubical sets with altitude functions alt_P and alt_Q . Then every bipointed map $f : P \rightarrow Q$ has $\text{alt}_Q(f(c)) = \text{alt}_P(c)$ for every cell c of P .*

Lemma 2.3. *Let $P, Q \in \square_*$ with $P \vee Q$ non-self-linked and admitting an altitude. Then concatenation $\text{Ch}(P) \times \text{Ch}(Q) \rightarrow \text{Ch}(P \vee Q)$ is an isomorphism.*

The events of a shape. The constructions presented in this paper are mostly bookkeeping of coordinates. To assist, we're going to define some helpers. First, let $\text{Ev}' : \mathbf{Cube} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ be the functor

1. sending objects I^n to its set of directions $[n]$
2. sending a face embedding $f : I^n \rightarrow I^m$ to the monotone injection $[n] \rightarrow [m]$ onto the directions that f leaves free.

Let Ev be the left Kan extension along Yoneda of the Ev' . Then Ev is cocontinuous and $\text{Ev}(I^0) = \emptyset$, so the pushout defining a wedge lifts to a coproduct:

$$\text{Ev}(\bigvee a) = \coprod_{i \in [r]} [a_i].$$

Its elements are the **events** of $\bigvee a$, the pairs (i, c) with $i \in [r]$ and $c \in [a_i]$, one for each direction of each block. We order the events lexicographically. Numbering them $1, \dots, N$ in this order, where $N = |a|$, identifies them with $[N]$, and we use whichever description is convenient. Let $\text{blk}_a(i, c) := i$. For a map f of serial wedges we write f_* for $\text{Ev}(f)$.

Proposition 2.4. *Let $f : \bigvee a \rightarrow \bigvee b$ in $\square_*$.*

- (i) *If $g : \bigvee a \rightarrow \bigvee b$ in $\square_*$ has $g_* = f_*$, then $g = f$.*
- (ii) *f_* is increasing on each block of a .*
- (iii) *There is a monotone map $\text{blk}(f)$ from the blocks of a to the blocks of b with*

$$\text{blk}_b \circ f_* = \text{blk}(f) \circ \text{blk}_a. \quad (1)$$

- (iv) *$|a| = |b|$, and f_* is a permutation of $[|a|]$.*

Proof. TODO: By the pushout definition of the wedge, and Lemmas 2.1 and 2.3 □

Presented categories. There are several equivalent definitions of 2-polygraph, also known as computads. But the following is a convenient choice for us. A **2-polygraph** $\mathcal{P}$ consists of a set $\mathcal{P}_0$ of **0-generators**, sets $\mathcal{P}_1(x, y)$ of **1-generators** and $\mathcal{P}_2(x, y)$ of **2-generators** for $x, y \in \mathcal{P}_0$, and maps

$$\text{src}, \text{tgt} : \mathcal{P}_2(x, y) \rightarrow \mathcal{P}_1^*(x, y),$$

where $\mathcal{P}_1^*$ is the free category on the 1-generators, whose morphisms are the **paths**. See [Ara+23, Def. 2.2.2] for the standard definition; ours is equivalent to it, with the endpoints of the generators built into the indexing. The 2-polygraphs form a category $\mathbf{Pol}_2$ [Ara+23, §2.2.3]. The category $\langle \mathcal{P} \rangle$ **presented by** $\mathcal{P}$ is the quotient of $\mathcal{P}_1^*$ by the smallest congruence identifying $\text{src}(\alpha)$ with $\text{tgt}(\alpha)$ for every 2-generator α [Ara+23, §2.3.3]. We write $q : \mathcal{P}_1^* \rightarrow \langle \mathcal{P} \rangle$ for the quotient functor.

Proposition 2.5. *Let $\mathcal{P}$ be a 2-polygraph and C a category.*

- (i) [Ara+23, Lem. 2.1.3] *Given an object of C for each 0-generator and an arrow of C for each 1-generator, with matching endpoints, there is a unique functor $\mathcal{P}_1^* \rightarrow C$ extending them.*
- (ii) [Ara+23, Lem. 2.3.4] *If $F : \mathcal{P}_1^* \rightarrow C$ is a functor with $F(\text{src } \alpha) = F(\text{tgt } \alpha)$ for every 2-generator α , then there is a unique functor $\bar{F} : \langle \mathcal{P} \rangle \rightarrow C$ with $\bar{F} \circ q = F$.*

(iii) A morphism of 2-polygraphs bijective on generators in every dimension is an isomorphism in $\mathbf{Pol}_2$.

Lemma 2.6. $\langle - \rangle$ extends to a functor $\mathbf{Pol}_2 \rightarrow \mathbf{Cat}$ with $\langle f \rangle \circ q = q \circ f^*$.

Proposition 2.5(iii) and Lemma 2.6 are routine, and we leave the details to the reader.

Proposition 2.7 ([GZ67, §I.1.1 and Lem. I.1.2]). *Let W be a class of morphisms of a category C . There is a functor $Q : C \rightarrow C[W^{-1}]$ inverting W . And for every category D , $(\cdot) \circ Q$ is an isomorphism from $C[W^{-1}] \rightarrow D$ onto the full subcategory of functors $C \rightarrow D$ that invert W .*

Newman's lemma. For a poset P , write $x \triangleleft y$ when y covers x , that is $x < y$ with no z such that $x < z < y$. The **Hasse diagram** $\text{Hasse}(P)$ is the quiver with vertex set P and one arrow $x \rightarrow y$ for each cover $x \triangleleft y$. A map of quivers $\text{Hasse}(P) \rightarrow C$ into a category extends to paths by composition, and we read it on paths without further comment. A functor $F : P \rightarrow C$ **extends** such a map φ when $F(x) = \varphi(x)$ for every $x \in P$ and $F(x \leq y) = \varphi(x \triangleleft y)$ for every cover $x \triangleleft y$.

The following is a variant of Newman's lemma [Ara+23, Lem. 1.3.21], and its proof is the same well-founded induction.

Lemma 2.8 (Newman's lemma for posets). *Let P be a finite poset and $\varphi : \text{Hasse}(P) \rightarrow C$ a map of quivers. Suppose that for every pair of distinct covers $x \triangleleft y_1$, $x \triangleleft y_2$ and every common upper bound z of y_1 and y_2 there are $j \leq z$ and paths p_i from y_i to j with*

$$\varphi(p_1) \circ \varphi(x \triangleleft y_1) = \varphi(p_2) \circ \varphi(x \triangleleft y_2).$$

Then φ extends uniquely to a functor $P \rightarrow C$.

Proof. Since P is finite, $x \leq z$ holds exactly when there is a path from x to z .

Any two extensions of φ agree: if F extends φ and w is a path from x to z , then $x \leq z$ is the composite of the covers along w , so $F(x \leq z) = \varphi(w)$.

For existence, it suffices to show that φ sends parallel paths to equal arrows. Then $F(x) := \varphi(x)$ and $F(x \leq z) := \varphi(w)$, for any path w from x to z , is well defined. It is a functor because the empty path gives identities and concatenation gives composites, and it extends φ because a cover is a path of length one.

So fix $z \in P$. We show, for every $x \in P$, that any two paths u, v from x to z have $\varphi(u) = \varphi(v)$, by induction on x downward: assume the claim for every $x' > x$.

If $x = z$ then u and v are both empty, since a nonempty path from x to z gives $x < z$. Otherwise there exist y_1 and y_2 giving $u = u' \circ (x \triangleleft y_1)$ and $v = v' \circ (x \triangleleft y_2)$. If $y_1 = y_2$, then $\varphi(u') = \varphi(v')$ by induction at y_1 . Otherwise z is a common upper bound of y_1 and y_2 , so the hypothesis gives $j \leq z$ and paths p_i from y_i to j with

$$\varphi(p_1) \varphi(x \triangleleft y_1) = \varphi(p_2) \varphi(x \triangleleft y_2).$$

Choose a path r from j to z , which exists as $j \leq z$. Then u' and $r \circ p_1$ are paths from y_1 to z , so $\varphi(u') = \varphi(r) \varphi(p_1)$ by induction at y_1 , and likewise $\varphi(v') = \varphi(r) \varphi(p_2)$. Hence

$$\varphi(u) = \varphi(r) \varphi(p_1) \varphi(x \triangleleft y_1) = \varphi(r) \varphi(p_2) \varphi(x \triangleleft y_2) = \varphi(v).$$

□

3 Squares, crossings, and $\text{Br}(K)$

► *One paragraph: a square is a pair of events of one block, and the whole construction runs on the question of which squares a map reverses.*

Throughout, a and b are shapes on N events.

Definition 3.1. Let $\text{Sq}' : \mathbf{Cube} \rightarrow \mathbf{Set}$ be the functor

1. sending I^n to its set of pairs of directions $\{(c, c') \in [n]^2 : c < c'\}$;
2. sending a face embedding $f : I^n \rightarrow I^m$ to $(c, c') \mapsto (\text{Ev}'(f)c, \text{Ev}'(f)c')$.

Let Sq be the left Kan extension along Yoneda of Sq' . The **squares** of a are the elements of $\text{Sq}(a) := \text{Sq}(\bigvee a)$.

Lemma 3.2. *As a set of pairs of events,*

$$\text{Sq}(a) = \{ (p, q) : p < q \text{ and } \text{blk}_a(p) = \text{blk}_a(q) \},$$

*and a map $f : \bigvee a \rightarrow \bigvee b$ of serial wedges has $\text{Sq}(f)(p, q) = (f_*p, f_*q)$. In particular $\text{Sq}(f)$ is injective.*

Proof. As for Ev , the functor Sq is cocontinuous and $\text{Sq}(I^0) = \emptyset$, so $\text{Sq}(\bigvee a) = \coprod_{i \in [r]} \text{Sq}'(I^{a_i})$, whose element $(i, (c, c'))$ is the pair of events $((i, c), (i, c'))$.

The two projections $\text{Sq}' \rightarrow \text{Ev}'$, sending (c, c') to c and to c' , are natural, so they extend to natural transformations $\epsilon_1, \epsilon_2 : \text{Sq} \rightarrow \text{Ev}$ with $\epsilon_1(p, q) = p$ and $\epsilon_2(p, q) = q$. For $k = 1, 2$, naturality at f is the square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Sq}(a) & \xrightarrow{\text{Sq}(f)} & \text{Sq}(b) \\ \epsilon_k \downarrow & & \downarrow \epsilon_k \\ \text{Ev}(\bigvee a) & \xrightarrow{f_*} & \text{Ev}(\bigvee b) \end{array}$$

and chasing (p, q) around it gives $\text{Sq}(f)(p, q) = (f_*p, f_*q)$. Injectivity follows, since f_* is a permutation (Proposition 2.4(iv)). $\square$

Definition 3.3. The **crossings** of a map of serial wedges $f : \bigvee a \rightarrow \bigvee b$ are the inversions of the relabelling it performs:

$$\text{Cr}(f) := \{ (p, q) : p < q \text{ and } f_*^{-1}(q) < f_*^{-1}(p) \}.$$

Lemma 3.4. *The map f_*^{-1} preserves the order of two events in distinct blocks of b . Hence $\text{Cr}(f) \subseteq \text{Sq}(b)$. A square (p, q) of b lies in $\text{im } \text{Sq}(f)$ if and only if $f_*^{-1}p$ and $f_*^{-1}q$ lie in one block of a .*

Proof. Let $u < v$ lie in distinct blocks of b , so $\text{blk}_b(u) < \text{blk}_b(v)$, and put $w = f_*^{-1}u$, $w' = f_*^{-1}v$. Then (1) gives $\text{blk}(f)(\text{blk}_a w) < \text{blk}(f)(\text{blk}_a w')$, so $\text{blk}_a(w) < \text{blk}_a(w')$ as $\text{blk}(f)$ is monotone, so $w < w'$ as blocks are intervals. An inversion of f_*^{-1} therefore has both events in one block of b . For the last claim, a square in the image pulls back to a square, whose events share a block; conversely if the two preimages share a block then, f_* being increasing there, they form a square mapping to (p, q) . $\square$

Lemma 3.5. For $f : \bigvee a \rightarrow \bigvee b$ and $g : \bigvee b \rightarrow \bigvee c$,

$$\text{Cr}(gf) = \text{Sq}(g)(\text{Cr } f) \sqcup \text{Cr}(g),$$

and $\text{Cr}(\text{id}) = \emptyset$.

Proof. Let s be a square of c . If $s = \text{Sq}(g)(t)$ then $s \notin \text{Cr}(g)$, the two events of t sharing a block (Lemma 3.4) — which also gives disjointness — and $(gf)_*^{-1}(g_*u) = f_*^{-1}(u)$ for the two events u of t , so $s \in \text{Cr}(gf)$ if and only if $t \in \text{Cr}(f)$. If $s \notin \text{im Sq}(g)$ then $s \notin \text{Sq}(g)(\text{Cr } f)$, and its two events pull back along g_* into distinct blocks of b , so the first claim of Lemma 3.4 applied to f gives $s \in \text{Cr}(gf)$ if and only if $s \in \text{Cr}(g)$. $\square$

Definition 3.6. A refinement f is **order preserving** when $\text{Cr}(f) = \emptyset$. Write $W = W_K$ for the class of order-preserving refinements of $\text{Ch}(K)$, and

$$\text{Br}(K) := \text{Ch}(K)^{\text{op}}[(W^{\text{op}})^{-1}].$$

Write $Q : \text{Ch}(K)^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{Br}(K)$ for the localization functor of Proposition 2.7. We leave the $^{\text{op}}$ on morphisms implicit: for a refinement $u : c \rightarrow d$ we write $Q(u) : Q(d) \rightarrow Q(c)$, so Q reverses composition.

Proposition 3.7. $\text{Br}(K) \simeq (\text{Ch}(K)[W^{-1}])^{\text{op}}$.

Proof. A functor $\text{Ch}(K)^{\text{op}} \rightarrow D$ inverting W^{op} is a functor $\text{Ch}(K) \rightarrow D^{\text{op}}$ inverting W , and conversely. So $(\text{Ch}(K)[W^{-1}])^{\text{op}}$ has the universal property Proposition 2.7 gives $\text{Br}(K)$. $\square$

Proposition 3.8. A refinement f is order preserving if and only if $f_* = \text{id}_{[N]}$. Hence W contains the identities; $gf \in W$ if and only if $f \in W$ and $g \in W$; any two order-preserving refinements with the same source and target are equal; and $\text{Ch}(u)$ carries W_K into W_L , so it descends to $\text{Br}(u) : \text{Br}(K) \rightarrow \text{Br}(L)$, strictly functorially in u .

Proof. A permutation with no inversions is the identity, and $\text{Cr}(f)$ is the inversion set of f_*^{-1} , so $\text{Cr}(f) = \emptyset$ if and only if $f_*^{-1} = \text{id}$, that is $f_* = \text{id}$. The consequences follow: the second from Lemma 3.5 with $\text{Sq}(g)$ injective (Lemma 3.2), the third because two such refinements f and f' have $f_* = \text{id} = f'_*$, so $f = f'$ by Proposition 2.4(i), and the last because $\text{Ch}(u)$ changes neither shape nor wedge map, with the descent given by Proposition 2.7. $\square$

► One or two sentences reading Proposition 3.8 back: an order-preserving refinement is one that only glues adjacent blocks, the elementary ones being $\bigvee[\dots, p, q, \dots] \rightarrow \bigvee[\dots, p + q, \dots]$.

4 The Artin polygraph of K

► Frame the section: the runs over a chain form a poset; its covers are the degree-one chains over that chain, and the rank-two intervals are the degree-two ones. That is the whole polygraph.

Fix K , and let d be a chain of K on N events.

4.1 Runs over a chain

Definition 4.1. A **run over** d is a refinement $x : X \rightarrow d$ whose source is a run; write $\mathcal{R}(d)$ for the set of these.

Such a refinement is determined by its map of wedges, the classifying map of its source being forced; that source has shape $[1, \dots, 1]$, so x_* enumerates the events of d (Proposition 2.4(iv)). Write $p <_x q$ when x_* reaches p first; then $\text{Cr}(x)$ is the inversion set of $<_x$.

Lemma 4.2. *If $\text{blk}(p) < \text{blk}(q)$ then $p <_x q$; hence blk is monotone for $<_x$, with interval fibres, and x is exactly a choice of linear order on each block. In particular Cr is injective on $\mathcal{R}(d)$.*

Proof. The blocks of the source are singletons, so $\text{blk} \circ x_* = \text{blk}(x)$, which is monotone by Proposition 2.4(iii). This is the first claim. A monotone surjection out of a chain has interval fibres, here the blocks of d . So $<_x$ is determined by its restriction to each block, and x is determined by $<_x$, since x_* is (Proposition 2.4(i)). Conversely, every choice of a linear order on each block arises: the edge path of I^n that raises the coordinates in a given order is a bipointed map $\bigvee[1, \dots, 1] \rightarrow I^n$, and concatenating these over the blocks of d gives a run over d with the chosen orders. Finally, a linear order is determined by its inversion set, and $\text{Cr}(x)$ restricts on each block to the inversion set there. $\square$

► *Note that for a single block, $\text{Cr}(x)$ is the set of inversions by value of the permutation sending each time to the event fired then, and inclusion of these sets is the weak order on the symmetric group [BB05, §3.1]; the order theory below is that statement, block by block. TODO: check which side (left or right) this is in the conventions of [BB05].*

We order $\mathcal{R}(d)$ by $x \leq y : \iff \text{Cr}(x) \subseteq \text{Cr}(y)$, and write $\perp_d$ and $\top_d$ for the runs taking each block in event order and in reverse, its least and greatest elements.

Proposition 4.3. *Let $q : o \rightarrow d$ be a refinement. Composition with q is an order embedding $\mathcal{R}(o) \rightarrow \mathcal{R}(d)$, and*

$$\text{Cr}(qx) = \text{Sq}(q)(\text{Cr } x) \sqcup \text{Cr}(q).$$

Moreover $q \perp_o = \perp_d$ if and only if $q \in W$; for $x \in \mathcal{R}(d)$ the conditions $x \in W$, $\text{Cr}(x) = \emptyset$ and $x = \perp_d$ agree; $\perp_X = \text{id}_X$ for a run X ; and $\text{dom } \perp_d = \text{dom } \perp_c$ whenever $c \rightarrow d$ lies in W .

Proof. The formula is Lemma 3.5. Since $\text{Sq}(q)$ is injective with image disjoint from $\text{Cr}(q)$ (Lemmas 3.2 and 3.4), $qx \leq qy$ if and only if $x \leq y$, and $\text{Cr}(q \perp_o) = \text{Cr}(q)$. The remaining equivalences are Definition 3.6 and the injectivity of Cr (Lemma 4.2), and the last clause is the formula applied to $c \rightarrow d$. $\square$

4.2 Steps, covers, and cells

A square s is a **step** of $x \in \mathcal{R}(d)$ when its two events are consecutive for $<_x$; the **flip** x^s is x with those two swapped.

Lemma 4.4. $\text{Cr}(x^s) = \text{Cr}(x) \triangle \{s\}$, and x has exactly $\deg d$ steps.

Proof. Swapping a consecutive pair changes the order of that pair and of no other. The steps are the covers of $<_x$ lying inside a block; $<_x$ is a chain on N elements and blk is a monotone surjection from it onto the r blocks (Lemma 4.2), and such a map collapses exactly $N - r = \deg d$ covers. $\square$

Lemma 4.5. *If $x < z$ in $\mathcal{R}(d)$ then $\text{Cr}(z)$ contains a step of x that $\text{Cr}(x)$ does not. Consequently $x < y$ exactly when $\text{Cr}(y) = \text{Cr}(x) \cup \{s\}$ for such a step s , and then $y = x^s$.*

Proof. If z agreed with x on every pair covering for $<_x$, then $<_x$ would be contained in $<_z$ by transitivity, and two linear orders so related are equal, so $z = x$. So some covering pair $p <_x q$ has $q <_z p$. Its two events share a block, since otherwise Lemma 4.2 would make every run fire p first, so the pair is a step s of x . If $s = (p, q)$ then $s \in \text{Cr}(z) \setminus \text{Cr}(x)$, as wanted; if $s = (q, p)$ then $s \in \text{Cr}(x) \subseteq \text{Cr}(z)$, which says $p <_z q$, a contradiction.

Given such an s we have $x \leq x^s \leq y$, forcing $y = x^s$; conversely if $\text{Cr}(y) = \text{Cr}(x) \cup \{s\}$ then any $x \leq w \leq y$ has $\text{Cr}(x) \subseteq \text{Cr}(w) \subseteq \text{Cr}(y)$, so w is x or y by injectivity (Lemma 4.2). $\square$

Say that a set S of steps of x **risers** from x when $S \cap \text{Cr}(x) = \emptyset$.

Proposition 4.6. *Let $x \in \mathcal{R}(d)$. Sending a factorisation $X \rightarrow m \rightarrow d$ of x to the set of steps of x whose two events share a block of m is a bijection onto the subsets of its set of steps. Write m_S for the middle it sends to S , and $\iota_S : X \rightarrow m_S$, $\pi_S : m_S \rightarrow d$ for the two legs. Then $\deg m_S = |S|$, and ι_S is order preserving whenever S rises from x .*

Proof. Let $x = \pi\iota$ with $\iota : X \rightarrow m$ and $\pi : m \rightarrow d$. The blocks of m , carried along π_* , partition the events of d into parts. Each part lies in one block of d , by (1) for π . Since $x_* = \pi_*\iota_*$, the order $<_x$ is carried from the firing order of ι , so by Lemma 4.2 applied to ι the parts are intervals of $<_x$, in the order of the blocks of m .

The partition determines the factorisation. The shape of m lists the sizes of the parts in $<_x$ -order. By Proposition 2.4(ii), π_* sends each block of m increasingly onto its part, so π_* is determined, hence so are π (Proposition 2.4(i)) and the classifying map $d\pi$ of m . Then $\iota_* = \pi_*^{-1}x_*$ is determined, hence so is ι . Conversely, every partition of the events into $<_x$ -intervals, each inside one block of d , arises from a factorisation. TODO: construct π blockwise from faces of the blocks of d , and ι from it.

A partition of a chain into intervals is determined by the set of covers lying inside a part, and every set of covers arises. When each part lies in one block of d , those covers are steps. Conversely, cutting at every cover outside a given set of steps cuts at every change of block (Lemma 4.2), so every part lies in one block. The covers inside a part are exactly the steps whose events share a block of m , which gives the bijection. Finally $\deg m$ is N minus the number of parts, which is the number of covers inside parts, so $\deg m_S = |S|$.

Let S rise from x . Since ι_S is a run over m_S , its crossings are the squares of m_S that x reverses, that is the pairs inside one part that x reverses. The covers of $<_x$ inside a part all lie in S , hence none is reversed, so $<_x$ agrees with the event order on consecutive pairs of the part and hence, by transitivity, on every pair of it. So $\text{Cr}(\iota_S) = \emptyset$. $\square$

Definition 4.7. For runs X, Y of K , an **n -cell** from X to Y is a chain e with $\deg e = n$, $\text{dom } \perp_e = X$ and $\text{dom } \top_e = Y$.

► *One sentence: so the n -cells are the chains of degree n , sorted by the two runs each spans, and a 0-cell is a run.*

Lemma 4.8. *Let S rise from $x \in \mathcal{R}(d)$. Then*

$$\text{Cr}(\pi_S \top_{m_S}) = \text{Cr}(x) \cup \text{im Sq}(\pi_S),$$

and every $z \geq x$ with $S \subseteq \text{Cr}(z)$ satisfies $\text{im Sq}(\pi_S) \subseteq \text{Cr}(z)$. So $\pi_S \top_{m_S}$ is the least element of $\mathcal{R}(d)$ above x reversing all of S .

Proof. Proposition 4.3 gives $\text{Cr}(\pi_S \top_{m_S}) = \text{im Sq}(\pi_S) \cup \text{Cr}(\pi_S)$, and Lemma 3.5 applied to $\pi_S \iota_S = x$ with $\text{Cr}(\iota_S) = \emptyset$ gives $\text{Cr}(\pi_S) = \text{Cr}(x)$.

For the second claim list a part as $p_1 < \dots < p_k$. This is also its $<_x$ -order: $\text{Cr}(\iota_S) = \emptyset$, so ι_S fires each block of m_S in event order, and π_{S*} is increasing on blocks. So each (p_i, p_{i+1}) is an uncut cover, lies in S and is reversed by z . Then $p_k <_z \dots <_z p_1$, so z reverses every pair of the part. $\square$

For a cover $x < y$ of $\mathcal{R}(d)$ with step s , put $\gamma(x < y) := m_{\{s\}}$.

Corollary 4.9. *Let $x < y$ in $\mathcal{R}(d)$, with step s . Then $\gamma(x < y)$ is a 1-cell from $\text{dom } x$ to $\text{dom } y$, with $\pi_{\{s\}} \perp_{m_{\{s\}}} = x$ and $\pi_{\{s\}} \top_{m_{\{s\}}} = y$; and every 1-cell α is γ of the unique cover $\perp_\alpha < \top_\alpha$ of $\mathcal{R}(\alpha)$. So γ , together with $x \mapsto \text{dom } x$ on vertices, is a map of quivers from $\text{Hase}(\mathcal{R}(d))$ to the quiver of 1-cells. Finally, for every refinement $q : o \rightarrow d$ and every cover e of $\mathcal{R}(o)$, qe is a cover of $\mathcal{R}(d)$ and $\gamma(qe) = \gamma(e)$.*

Proof. Write $m = m_{\{s\}}$. By Lemma 4.5, $s \notin \text{Cr}(x)$, so $\{s\}$ rises from x and $\iota_{\{s\}}$ is order preserving (Proposition 4.6), hence equals $\perp_m$ (Proposition 4.3). So $\pi_{\{s\}} \perp_m = x$ and $\text{dom } \perp_m = \text{dom } x$, and $\deg m = 1$. By Lemma 4.8, $\pi_{\{s\}} \top_m$ is the least element above x that reverses s , which is $x^s = y$ (Lemma 4.5); so $\text{dom } \top_m = \text{dom } y$.

Conversely a chain α of degree 1 has one square, so $\mathcal{R}(\alpha)$ is the two-element poset $\perp_\alpha < \top_\alpha$ (Lemma 4.2). The factorisation $\perp_\alpha = \text{id}_\alpha \circ \perp_\alpha$ has middle α , whose one block of dimension 2 contains the one step, so $\gamma(\perp_\alpha < \top_\alpha) = \alpha$ by Proposition 4.6.

For the last claim let $e = (x < y)$ with step s . By Proposition 4.3, $\text{Cr}(qy) = \text{Cr}(qx) \sqcup \{\text{Sq}(q)(s)\}$, so $qx < qy$ with step $\text{Sq}(q)(s)$ (Lemma 4.5). The factorisation $qx = (q\pi_{\{s\}}) \iota_{\{s\}}$ has middle m , and since $(qx)_* = q_* x_*$ the only step of qx whose events share a block of m is $\text{Sq}(q)(s)$. By the bijection of Proposition 4.6, $\gamma(qe) = m = \gamma(e)$. $\square$

4.3 The attachment of a 2-cell

Proposition 4.10. *Let $\deg e = 2$. Then either e has one block of dimension 3 and $|\text{Sq}(e)| = 3$, or e has two blocks of dimension 2 and $|\text{Sq}(e)| = 2$. In both cases $\mathcal{R}(e)$ has exactly two maximal chains from $\perp_e$ to $\top_e$, each of length $|\text{Sq}(e)|$, and they leave $\perp_e$ by different covers. Write $\text{src}(e)$ and $\text{tgt}(e)$ for the paths of 1-cells that γ reads off them, labelled so that $\text{src}(e)$ begins with the least square for the lexicographic order on $\text{Sq}(e)$, by the smaller event and then the larger.*

Proof. $\deg e = 2$ forces the block dimensions above 1 to be $\{3\}$ or $\{2, 2\}$, and Lemma 3.2 counts $\binom{3}{2} = 3$ squares in the first case and $2\binom{2}{2} = 2$ in the second. A run over e is a linear order on each block (Lemma 4.2) and each cover swaps a consecutive pair (Lemma 4.5).

Two blocks of dimension 2 therefore give four runs, the Boolean lattice on s_1, s_2 . One block of dimension 3, on events $p < q < r$, gives six, with covers

$$pqr < qpr < qrp < rqp, \quad pqr < prq < rpq < rqp,$$

a hexagon. These are all of them: every run has exactly two steps (Lemma 4.4) and each step gives a neighbour, up or down according to whether it is already reversed (Lemma 4.5), and every vertex displayed already has two. So the two displayed chains are the only maximal ones, and they leave $\perp_e$ by different covers. $\square$

In both cases $\text{src}(e)$ reverses the squares of e in lexicographic order and $\text{tgt}(e)$ in the reverse order, as the chains displayed in the proof show.¹

The two species are drawn in Figure 1 and Figure 2.

Definition 4.11. The **Artin polygraph** $\text{Art}(K)$ has the runs of K as 0-generators. Its 1-generators and 2-generators from X to Y are the 1-cells and 2-cells from X to Y of Definition 4.7, that is the chains of degree 1 and 2 spanning those two runs. For a 2-generator e , $\text{src}(e)$ and $\text{tgt}(e)$ are the paths of Proposition 4.10.

► *One paragraph on the name: $\text{Art}(K)$ is built from K alone, with no braid theory in it, and Proposition 4.10 already exhibits its 2-generators as braid and commutation relations; Theorem 7.5 is what makes the name literal.*

Proposition 4.12. Read in $\langle \text{Art}(K) \rangle$, the map of quivers γ satisfies the hypothesis of Lemma 2.8 on $\mathcal{R}(d)$. So it extends uniquely to a functor $\Gamma_d : \mathcal{R}(d) \rightarrow \langle \text{Art}(K) \rangle$, and $\Gamma_d(qx) = \Gamma_o(x)$ for every refinement $q : o \rightarrow d$ and every $x \in \mathcal{R}(o)$.

Proof. Let $x \leq y_1$, $x \leq y_2$ be distinct covers with steps $s_1 \neq s_2$, and z a common upper bound. Then $S = \{s_1, s_2\}$ rises from x , so m_S is a chain of degree 2, that is a 2-cell (Proposition 4.6), and $j := \pi_S \top_{m_S}$ satisfies $j \leq z$ (Lemma 4.8). By Proposition 4.10 the two maximal chains of $\mathcal{R}(m_S)$ are $\text{src}(m_S)$ and $\text{tgt}(m_S)$, and they leave $\perp_{m_S}$ by its two covers. Since S rises from x , ι_S is order preserving, hence equals $\perp_{m_S}$ (Proposition 4.6, Proposition 4.3). So composition with π_S carries $\perp_{m_S}$ to x and $\top_{m_S}$ to j , and it carries covers to covers and keeps the 1-cell each cover reads as (Corollary 4.9). So the two chains become two paths from x to j , leaving by y_1 and by y_2 and reading as $\text{src}(m_S)$ and $\text{tgt}(m_S)$, which are equal in $\langle \text{Art}(K) \rangle$.

For the last claim, composition with q is monotone, so $x \mapsto \Gamma_d(qx)$ and Γ_o are functors out of $\mathcal{R}(o)$. Both extend γ on $\mathcal{R}(o)$, because composition with q keeps domains, carries covers to covers and keeps γ (Corollary 4.9). So they are equal, by the uniqueness in Lemma 2.8. $\square$

5 The presentation

► *Frame the proof as a comparison of two universal properties: a functor out of $\langle \text{Art}(K) \rangle$ is an arrow for each degree-one chain identifying $\text{src}(e)$ and $\text{tgt}(e)$ for every degree-two chain e (Proposition 2.5), and a functor out of $\text{Br}(K)$ is a functor on $\text{Ch}(K)^{\text{op}}$ inverting W (Proposition 2.7). Each is built from the other.*

Fix K throughout this section, and write E , Θ , Φ for the functors called E_K , Θ_K , Φ_K elsewhere.

¹The formalisation [Sto26] works with the sets $\text{Cr}(x)$ in place of the orders $<_x$: `reversedIso` identifies $\mathcal{R}(d)$ with the subsets of $\text{Sq}(d)$ that are *biclosed*, meaning that no block's induced tournament has a directed 3-cycle, and it takes the last sentence above as the definition of the two paths. The four and the six runs are `card_biclosed_of_isEmpty_triangles` and `card_biclosed_of_triangle`, and this proposition is derived twice there: as `eq_srcPath_or_tgtPath_of_triangles`, from `subsingleton_triangles` and `biclosed_iff_of_triangle`, and as `eq_srcPath_or_tgtPath`, from 2-regularity of $\text{Hasse}(\mathcal{R}(e))$.

► *One sentence: every arrow of $\text{Br}(K)$ written down below is a composite $Q(g)Q(m)^{-1}$, and every identity used about them is an instance of Q being a functor.*

An n -cell α from X to Y comes with the two refinements $\perp_\alpha : X \rightarrow \alpha$ and $\top_\alpha : Y \rightarrow \alpha$, of which the first is order preserving; since Q inverts $\perp_\alpha$, we may set

$$E(X) := Q(X), \quad E(\alpha) := Q(\top_\alpha) \circ Q(\perp_\alpha)^{-1} : Q(X) \rightarrow Q(Y).$$

Lemma 5.1. *Let d be a chain and $z \in \mathcal{R}(d)$. Every path from $\perp_d$ to z in $\text{Hasse}(\mathcal{R}(d))$ reads, under $E \circ \gamma$, as $Q(z) \circ Q(\perp_d)^{-1}$. Consequently E extends to a functor $\langle \text{Art}(K) \rangle \rightarrow \text{Br}(K)$.*

Proof. Induct on the length of the path, the empty path reading as the identity. For a cover $x \leq y$ with step s , put $\beta := \gamma(x \leq y)$ and $q := \pi_{\{s\}}$, so $x = q\perp_\beta$ and $y = q\top_\beta$ (Corollary 4.9), so $Q(x) = Q(\perp_\beta)Q(q)$. The middle two factors of

$$E(\beta) \circ Q(x) \circ Q(\perp_d)^{-1} = Q(\top_\beta) \circ Q(\perp_\beta)^{-1} \circ Q(\perp_\beta) \circ Q(q) \circ Q(\perp_d)^{-1}$$

cancel, leaving $Q(\top_\beta)Q(q)Q(\perp_d)^{-1} = Q(y)Q(\perp_d)^{-1}$.

For the extension, Proposition 2.5(i) extends E to a functor $\text{Art}(K)_1^* \rightarrow \text{Br}(K)$. For a 2-generator e , $\text{src}(e)$ and $\text{tgt}(e)$ are both paths from $\perp_e$ to $\top_e$ in $\text{Hasse}(\mathcal{R}(e))$ (Proposition 4.10), so they have equal image, and Proposition 2.5(ii) gives the functor on $\langle \text{Art}(K) \rangle$. $\square$

Lemma 5.2. *Setting $\Theta(d) := \text{dom } \perp_d$ and, for a refinement $u : c \rightarrow d$,*

$$\Theta(u) := \Gamma_d(\perp_d \leq u\perp_c) : \text{dom } \perp_d \rightarrow \text{dom } \perp_c,$$

defines a functor $\Theta : \text{Ch}(K)^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \langle \text{Art}(K) \rangle$; it sends u to an identity whenever u is order preserving, so it descends uniquely to $\Phi : \text{Br}(K) \rightarrow \langle \text{Art}(K) \rangle$ with $\Phi Q = \Theta$.

Proof. The stated target is the right one: $u\perp_c$ lies in $\mathcal{R}(d)$ with source $\text{dom } \perp_c$. Let $v : b \rightarrow c$ and $u : c \rightarrow d$. Composition with u is monotone (Proposition 4.3), so $\perp_d \leq u\perp_c \leq uv\perp_b$, and Γ_d being a functor, $\Theta(uv) = \Gamma_d(u\perp_c \leq uv\perp_b) \circ \Theta(u)$; the left factor is $\Gamma_c(\perp_c \leq v\perp_b) = \Theta(v)$ by the last clause of Proposition 4.12. If u is order preserving then $u\perp_c = \perp_d$ (Proposition 4.3), so the comparison is an identity. The descent is Proposition 2.7. $\square$

Theorem 5.3. *For every bipointed precubical set K , the functor E is an equivalence $\langle \text{Art}(K) \rangle \rightarrow \text{Br}(K)$, with Φ inverse to it.*

Proof. On a 0-cell, $\Phi(E(X)) = \Theta(X) = \text{dom } \perp_X = X$ (Proposition 4.3). On a 1-cell α , applying Φ to the defining composite gives $\Phi(E(\alpha)) = \Theta(\top_\alpha) \circ \Theta(\perp_\alpha)^{-1}$, whose second factor is an identity because $\perp_\alpha$ is order preserving (Lemma 5.2). Since $\top_\alpha \perp_Y = \top_\alpha$ and $\mathcal{R}(\alpha)$ is the two-element poset $\perp_\alpha \leq \top_\alpha$,

$$\Theta(\top_\alpha) = \Gamma_\alpha(\perp_\alpha \leq \top_\alpha) = q(\gamma(\perp_\alpha \leq \top_\alpha)) = q(\alpha)$$

by Corollary 4.9. So $\Phi E q$ and q agree on generators, and $\Phi E = \text{id}$ by the uniqueness in Proposition 2.5(i) and (ii).

For the other composite, Lemma 5.1 gives $E(\Theta(u)) = Q(u\perp_c)Q(\perp_d)^{-1} = Q(\perp_c) \circ Q(u) \circ Q(\perp_d)^{-1}$, which is $Q(u)$ conjugated by the isomorphisms $Q(\perp_c)$ and $Q(\perp_d)$. So the $Q(\perp_d)$ form a natural isomorphism $Q \cong E\Theta = E\Phi Q$, and since precomposition with Q is an isomorphism onto a full subcategory (Proposition 2.7), it is ηQ for a unique natural transformation $\eta : \text{id} \Rightarrow E\Phi$, which is invertible because ηQ is. $\square$

► *One sentence: the comparison is an equivalence and not an isomorphism because $\text{Br}(K)$ is not skeletal — a chain and the run below it become isomorphic there without being equal — so the runs are a skeleton of $\text{Br}(K)$.*

6 Naturality

Theorem 6.1. *Sending K to $\text{Art}(K)$, and $f : K \rightarrow L$ to $\text{Ch}(f)$ on generators in every dimension, is a functor $\square_* \rightarrow \mathbf{Pol}_2$; and for every $f : K \rightarrow L$,*

$$E_L \circ \langle \text{Art}(f) \rangle = \text{Br}(f) \circ E_K : \langle \text{Art}(K) \rangle \longrightarrow \text{Br}(L).$$

Proof. A run over a chain e is determined by its map of wedges (Definition 4.1), and $\text{Ch}(f)e$ has the same shape and the same maps of wedges into it, so $\mathcal{R}(e) = \mathcal{R}(\text{Ch}(f)e)$ as ordered sets. Crossings, steps, flips and γ (Definition 3.3, Corollary 4.9) are read off the map of wedges alone, so $\text{Ch}(f)$ preserves $\perp$, $\top$, cells, steps, covers and γ ; and it carries the lexicographic order on $\text{Sq}(e)$ to the lexicographic order on $\text{Sq}(\text{Ch}(f)e) = \text{Sq}(e)$, so it preserves src and tgt letter by letter. Hence $\text{Art}(f)$ is a morphism of 2-polygraphs, functorially in f because Ch is a functor.

Both composites send a run X to $Q(\text{Ch}(f)X)$. Let α be a 1-generator of $\text{Art}(K)$. By Lemma 2.6, $E_L \circ \langle \text{Art}(f) \rangle$ sends $q(\alpha)$ to $E_L(\text{Ch}(f)\alpha)$. On the other side, $\text{Br}(f)$ is the descent of the functor induced by $\text{Ch}(f)$, so it sends $E_K(\alpha)$ to $Q(\text{Ch}(f)\top_\alpha) \circ Q(\text{Ch}(f)\perp_\alpha)^{-1}$. Here $\text{Ch}(f)\perp_\alpha$ is an order-preserving refinement into $\text{Ch}(f)\alpha$ out of a run, hence is $\perp_{\text{Ch}(f)\alpha}$ (Proposition 4.3), and $\text{Ch}(f)\top_\alpha = \top_{\text{Ch}(f)\alpha}$ because both reverse every square. So $\text{Br}(f) \circ E_K$ also sends $q(\alpha)$ to $E_L(\text{Ch}(f)\alpha)$. Precomposed with q , the two composites agree on generators, so they are equal by the uniqueness in Proposition 2.5(i) and (ii). $\square$

► *One sentence: the square is an equality, not an isomorphism, because an order-preserving refinement is determined by its source and target (Proposition 3.8), so transporting the two legs of a cell involves no choice. The tree states the equality, **paperSquare**, and derives the comparison isomorphism from it as **eqToIso**.*

7 The point

Since Z is terminal, every serial wedge has exactly one bipointed map to it and every map of wedges commutes over it, so $\text{Ch}(Z)$ is the category of shapes and maps of wedges. Write Z_N for the run of Z on N events. Both $\perp_e$ and $\top_e$ have source a run on $|e|$ events, so every cell of Z is a loop at $Z_{|e|}$.

For a shape a on N events put $\text{cut}(a) := \{k \in [N-1] : \text{blk}_a(k) = \text{blk}_a(k+1)\}$, and for $i \neq k$ in $[N-1]$ let $\text{cox}(i, k) := 3$ when $|i - k| = 1$ and $\text{cox}(i, k) := 2$ otherwise.

Lemma 7.1. *$a \mapsto \text{cut}(a)$ is a bijection from the shapes on N events onto the subsets of $[N-1]$, with $|\text{cut}(a)| = \deg a$. Hence the n -cells at Z_N are the n -element subsets of $[N-1]$. A chain e of Z with $\deg e = 2$ and $\text{cut}(e) = \{i < k\}$ has $|\text{Sq}(e)| = \text{cox}(i, k)$.*

Proof. A shape on N events is a composition of N and $\text{cut}(a)$ is the complement of its set of block boundaries in $[N-1]$, so the first claim is the classical correspondence [Sta12, §1.2] and $|\text{cut}(a)| = N - r = \deg a$. For the last claim, e has a block of dimension 3 exactly when three consecutive events share a block, that is exactly when $k = i + 1$; then $|\text{Sq}(e)| = 3$, and otherwise $|\text{Sq}(e)| = 2$, by Proposition 4.10. $\square$

Write σ_k for the 1-cell at Z_N with $\text{cut} = \{k\}$. For a step s of x , write $\text{pos}_x(s)$ for the earlier of the two positions $<_x$ gives the events of s ; so x passes s between positions $\text{pos}_x(s)$ and $\text{pos}_x(s) + 1$.

Lemma 7.2. *Let d be a chain on N events and $x \in \mathcal{R}(d)$. Then:*

- (i) pos_x is a bijection from the steps of x onto $\text{cut}(d)$;
- (ii) $\text{pos}_{x^s}(s) = \text{pos}_x(s)$;
- (iii) $\text{pos}_{\perp_d}(s) = p$, where $s = (p, q)$.

If d is a chain of Z , then a cover $x \prec y$ with step s has $\gamma(x \prec y) = \sigma_{\text{pos}_x(s)}$.

Proof. (i) The fibres of blk for $<_x$ are consecutive intervals of lengths $a_1, \dots, a_r$ (Lemma 4.2), independent of x , so the set of positions t with t and $t + 1$ in one block is $\text{cut}(d)$ for every x . A step is a cover of $<_x$ inside a block, so pos_x lands in $\text{cut}(d)$, and it is injective because distinct covers of a chain have distinct lower ends; both sides have $\deg d$ elements (Lemma 4.4, Lemma 7.1). (ii) Flipping s exchanges its two times and changes no other. (iii) $\perp_d$ fires the events in their own order.

For the last claim, $\gamma(x \prec y) = m_{\{s\}}$, whose blocks are the parts of $<_x$ cut at every cover but s (Proposition 4.6); so $m_{\{s\}}$ has one block of dimension 2, at positions $\text{pos}_x(s)$ and $\text{pos}_x(s) + 1$, and edges elsewhere, so its cut set is $\{\text{pos}_x(s)\}$. $\square$

Proposition 7.3. *Let e be a chain of Z with $\deg e = 2$ and $\text{cut}(e) = \{i < k\}$. Then*

$$\text{src}(e) = \sigma_i \sigma_k \sigma_i \cdots, \quad \text{tgt}(e) = \sigma_k \sigma_i \sigma_k \cdots,$$

both of length $\text{cox}(i, k) = |\text{Sq}(e)|$.

Proof. A cover with step s reads as $\sigma_{\text{pos}_x(s)}$ (Lemma 7.2), so it is enough to read the two chains of Proposition 4.10, and $\perp_e$ passes (p, q) at p (Lemma 7.2(iii)).

If $k > i + 1$ then e has blocks of dimension 2 at positions $\{i, i + 1\}$ and $\{k, k + 1\}$ (Lemma 7.1), with squares s_1 and s_2 . Flipping s_1 moves only the events at positions i and $i + 1$, so s_2 stays at position k , and vice versa. So the two chains read $\sigma_i \sigma_k$ and $\sigma_k \sigma_i$.

If $k = i + 1$ then e has one block of dimension 3, on the events at positions $i, i + 1, i + 2$. Along the two chains displayed in the proof of Proposition 4.10, with p, q, r at positions $i, i + 1, i + 2$, the swapped pair sits at positions $i, i + 1, i$ and at $i + 1, i, i + 1$.

The lengths are $|\text{Sq}(e)| = \text{cox}(i, k)$ (Lemma 7.1). $\square$

Definition 7.4. **Artin's braid polygraph $\mathcal{A}$** has one 0-generator for each $N \in \mathbb{N}$; at N , the 1-generators $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_{N-1}$, each a loop; and, for each pair $i < k$ in $[N - 1]$, one 2-generator e with $\text{src}(e) = \sigma_i \sigma_k \sigma_i \cdots$ and $\text{tgt}(e) = \sigma_k \sigma_i \sigma_k \cdots$, both of length $\text{cox}(i, k)$.

► *One or two sentences: unwind Definition 7.4 to Artin's relations [Art47], so $\langle \mathcal{A} \rangle$ has endomorphism monoid B_N^+ at N and no arrows between distinct objects.*

Write **Braid**⁺ for the category with objects $N \in \mathbb{N}$, no arrows between distinct objects, and $\text{End}(N) = B_N^+$ composed left to right, as we read words.

Theorem 7.5. $\text{Art}(Z) \cong \mathcal{A}$ in **Pol**₂.

Proof. The runs of Z are the Z_N and every cell of Z is a loop, so both polygraphs are disjoint unions over N and it suffices to compare at each N . There the 1-generators are indexed by $[N - 1]$ and the 2-generators by the pairs $i < k$ (Lemma 7.1), and by Proposition 7.3 src and tgt of the 2-generator at $\{i < k\}$ are those of Definition 7.4. The resulting morphism of 2-polygraphs is bijective on generators in every dimension, hence an isomorphism (Proposition 2.5(iii)). $\square$

Corollary 7.6. $\text{Br}(Z) \simeq \mathbf{Braid}^+$.

Proof. By Theorem 5.3 at $K = Z$, $\text{Br}(Z) \simeq \langle \text{Art}(Z) \rangle$, and by Theorem 7.5 and Lemma 2.6, $\langle \text{Art}(Z) \rangle \cong \langle \mathcal{A} \rangle$. TODO: $\langle \mathcal{A} \rangle \cong \mathbf{Braid}^+$, which is the unwinding promised after Definition 7.4, with the left-to-right composition convention. $\square$

► *Closing paragraph: combining with Theorem 6.1, the terminal map gives $\text{Br}(!_K) : \text{Br}(K) \rightarrow \text{Br}(Z)$, computed cell by cell — a degree-one chain goes to σ_{pos} for the position at which its run passes its one step, a degree-two chain to the relation of its two positions. Say what this sharpens in [PZ21]. Note that Matsumoto’s theorem plays no role, B_N^+ being taken here as Artin’s presentation.*

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